

‘*Concordia discors*’ and f³⁵ minority readings in the General Epistles

Over a century ago, and throughout his works, John William Burgon repeatedly called attention to the *concordia discors*, the prevailing confusion and disagreement, which the early uncials (ⲚABCD—he personally collated each) display between/among themselves. Luke 11:2-4 offers one example.

“The five Old Uncials” (ⲚABCD) falsify the Lord’s Prayer as given by St. Luke in no less than forty-five words. But so little do they agree among themselves, that they throw themselves into six different combinations in their departures from the Traditional Text; and yet they are never able to agree among themselves as to one single various reading: while only once are more than two of them observed to stand together, and their grand point of union is no less than an omission of the article. Such is their eccentric tendency, that in respect of thirty-two out of the whole forty-five words they bear in turn solitary evidence.¹

James

Concordia discors

Four of those uncials are extant in James (ⲚABC), to which I add P^{20,100} and 048,² and what Burgon calls their ‘eccentric tendency’ is plainly visible. Their eccentricity, viewed from the perspective of the normal transmission, is sufficient to warm the cockles of the heart of the most obdurate iconoclast. However, their very eccentricity establishes their independence, which is of special interest in what follows. I proceed to tabulate their performance in the 120 relevant variant sets (excluding 5 with *rell*) included in the critical apparatus of my edition of the Greek Text of James. I do so using f³⁵ as the point of reference.

f ³⁵ alone	53	[In these cases the uncials are usually together, but not always.]
f ³⁵ P ¹⁰⁰	2	
f ³⁵ Ⲛ	6	
f ³⁵ A	9	

¹ Burgon, *The Traditional Text of the Holy Gospels Vindicated and Established*, arranged, completed, and edited by Edward Miller (London: George Bell and Sons, 1986), p. 84.

² P²³, 0173 and 0246, all fragmentary, are also cited in my apparatus, but they never agree with f³⁵ against the rest.